

## Mekhel Powell

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### SUMMARY

Georgia Tech M.S. Cybersecurity candidate with hands-on enterprise experience triaging endpoint telemetry via SentinelOne Singularity XDR and Red Canary. Experienced in preparing CMMC compliance documentation and building Power BI/Power Automate pipelines to streamline AI tool procurement workflows. Brings a strong foundation in enterprise networking concepts, Linux/Windows virtualization, and practical lab work in threat analysis, vulnerability assessment, and security automation.

### EDUCATION

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>Georgia Institute of Technology</b><br><i>M.S Cybersecurity, Cybersecurity and Privacy</i>     | Expected December 2026<br>GPA: 3.71 |
| <b>Georgia State University</b><br><i>Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Honors College</i> | Fall 2021-Summer 2025<br>GPA: 3.72  |

### SKILLS

- Cybersecurity Tools & Platforms: Wireshark, Docker, VMWare, Ghidra, Red Canary, Sentinel One Singularity XDR, Wazuh SIEM, AWS (EC2), MITRE ATT&CK Framework, Power BI, Power Automate
- Programming & Scripting: Python, C/C++, PowerShell, Java, React
- Operating Systems & Environments: Linux (Kali, Ubuntu, Debian), Windows (Server and Enterprise)

### CERTIFICATIONS

- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA) – Expected: November 2026

### WORK EXPERIENCE

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| <b>YKK Corporation of America</b><br><i>Cybersecurity Intern</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Atlanta, GA<br>Jan 2025 - Apr 2025    |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Utilized SentinelOne Singularity XDR and Red Canary to monitor and triage endpoint telemetry across the YKK Americas enterprise, managing high-volume alert traffic and ensuring all critical threats were escalated for immediate incident response.</li><li>• Strengthened regional security posture by preparing system documentation for CMMC compliance assessments and engineering automated Power BI and Power Automate workflows to streamline enterprise AI tool procurement and review tracking.</li></ul> |                                       |
| <b>Georgia Tech – Bridge UP STEM Program</b><br><i>Student Assistant</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Atlanta, GA<br>Summer 2025            |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Facilitated technical STEM workshops for 30+ high school students, providing advanced Python troubleshooting and debugging support during hands-on coding sessions.</li><li>• Mentored high school students on cybersecurity career pathways and technical fundamentals, translating complex computing concepts into actionable learning objectives</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                        |                                       |
| <b>Georgia State University – Upward Bound Program</b><br><i>Tutor-Counselor</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Atlanta, GA<br>Summer 2022 – Dec 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Instructed high school students in fundamental Computer Science and mathematics, breaking down core programming and analytical concepts into accessible classroom modules.</li><li>• Provided structured technical mentorship to 100+ students, designing targeted STEM workshops and coding exercises that improved academic performance and prepared candidates for college-level computing curricula</li></ul>                                                                                                    |                                       |

### PROJECT EXPERIENCE

#### Cloud Threat Deception and SIEM Telemetry

##### *Detection Engineering & Cloud Security*

- Deployed an AWS EC2 Cowrie SSH honeypot using iptables redirection, streaming 90,000+ JSON threat events over mTLS to a Wazuh SIEM cluster for real-time brute-force and command analysis
- Authored custom XML detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK (T1078, T1046), enriched attacker coordinates via GeoIP pipelines, and audited host posture against CIS Ubuntu Benchmarks.

#### Phishing Email Detection System

##### *Network Security – Georgia State University*

- Engineered a Python-based classifier achieving 96.8% accuracy across 100,000+ email records, evaluating look-alike domains, suspicious header metadata, and urgent NLP-derived sentiment via Scikit-learn.
- Developed a full stack React interface to ingest and evaluate incoming email telemetry in real time, translating backend ML classification logic into actionable risk scores and automated threat indicators.

### RELEVANT COURSEWORK

- Information Security Lab: Malware & Threat Analysis, Software Security (Fuzzing/SRE), Web and Mobile Security
- Secure Computer Systems: Trusted Computing Base, Access Control Mechanisms, Distributed System Security.
- Info Security Strategies & Policy: Risk Management, CMMC/Regulatory Frameworks, International Cyber Policy.
- Data Privacy and Law: Privacy technology, IAPP Privacy by Design, Information Security Strategies and Policies